

CONSULTATION MODULE

Frontend Integration Guide

Digital consultation booking, video/audio sessions, and prescriptions

API v1 · Backend: Django REST Framework

Last updated: August 30, 2026

1. Overview

This guide documents the HTTP API for the Consultation module: booking a digital consultation, managing its lifecycle (start / complete / cancel), and issuing prescriptions. It is written for engineers building the patient-facing and doctor-facing web/mobile clients.

Specialties, doctor listings, and doctor availability are owned by a separate Doctors module, not this one — Section 5 gives the minimum needed to drive the booking flow, but treat that module's own integration guide as the source of truth for those endpoints.

Mount paths

Mount paths used throughout this guide: the Consultation module is mounted at `/api/consultations/` (confirmed). The Doctors module is mounted at `/api/` directly — its own `urls.py` already prefixes routes with `specialties/` and `doctors/`, so no extra segment is added at the root. Confirm both against the project's root `urls.py` before wiring up requests.

Known limitations

This document reflects the module's current server-side implementation. Two gaps are called out explicitly in Sections 6.6 and 8 (no list endpoint for a doctor's own consultations, and no notification/websocket channel for status changes) — plan the doctor dashboard and the “join call” UX around those constraints until they are added.

1.1 Quick reference — Consultation module (`/api/consultations/`)

Method	Path	Purpose
POST	<code>/api/consultations/</code>	Book a consultation (patient)
GET	<code>/api/consultations/mine/</code>	List the authenticated patient's consultations
GET	<code>/api/consultations/{id}/</code>	Get one consultation (patient)
POST	<code>/api/consultations/{id}/cancel/</code>	Cancel a consultation (patient)
POST	<code>/api/consultations/{id}/start/</code>	Start a consultation (doctor)
POST	<code>/api/consultations/{id}/complete/</code>	Complete a consultation (doctor)
POST	<code>/api/consultations/{id}/prescriptions/</code>	Add a prescription (doctor)

1.2 Quick reference — Doctors module (`/api/`), needed before booking

Method	Path	Purpose
GET	<code>/api/specialties/</code>	List active specialties
GET	<code>/api/doctors/</code>	List doctors (optional <code>?specialty=</code>)
GET	<code>/api/doctors/{id}/availability/</code>	List a doctor's availability windows

2. Authentication

Every endpoint requires an authenticated request — send the project's standard bearer/session credential on every call. Two additional identity checks are layered on top of authentication:

- Patient-only endpoints require the authenticated user to have a linked Patient profile.
- Doctor-only endpoints require the authenticated user to have a linked Doctor profile.

A user without the right profile gets 403 Forbidden with a plain-language detail message (e.g. “Only patients can access this resource.”) rather than a validation error — treat this as a role/account problem in the UI, not a form error.

3. Conventions

3.1 Content type

All requests and responses use application/json. Dates are ISO 8601 (YYYY-MM-DD), times are HH:MM:SS (24-hour, local server time), and datetimes are ISO 8601 with a UTC offset.

3.2 Error shape

Two distinct error shapes appear across the module — the frontend should handle both:

- Field validation errors (400, from a serializer) — an object keyed by field name, each value a list of messages:

```
{
  "appointment_date": ["Appointment date cannot be in the past."]
}
```

- Business-rule errors (400/403/404, raised by the service layer or lookups) — a single “detail” string:

```
{
  "detail": "This slot is no longer available. Please choose another time."
}
```

Always check for a "detail" key first; if absent, treat the body as a field-error map and surface messages next to the matching form fields.

3.3 HTTP status summary

Status	Meaning in this module
200 OK	Successful GET, or a successful state-changing POST (cancel/start/complete)
201 Created	Successful booking or prescription creation
400 Bad Request	Validation failure or a business rule was violated (see detail/field body)
403 Forbidden	Authenticated, but wrong role (not a patient / not a doctor), or not the assigned doctor

Status	Meaning in this module
404 Not Found	Object doesn't exist, or exists but doesn't belong to the requesting user
Note 404 is also returned when a consultation exists but belongs to a different patient/doctor — the API does not distinguish “not found” from “not yours”, by design, to avoid leaking existence of other users' records.	

4. Data model reference

Enumerated fields the frontend will branch on. Values are the wire values (what appears in JSON); labels are for display only if you ever pull them from a separate metadata endpoint.

4.1 Consultation.status

Value	Meaning
scheduled	Booked; appointment is confirmed but the session hasn't started
waiting	Reserved for a future “patient is in the waiting room” flow — not yet set by any endpoint below
in_progress	Session has been started by the doctor
completed	Session finished normally
cancelled	Cancelled before it started
no_show	Reserved value — not yet set by any endpoint below

4.2 Consultation.consultation_type / language

Field	Values
consultation_type	video (default) · audio
language	en (default) · am

4.3 Appointment.status

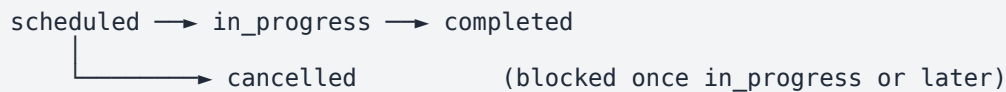
Surfaced on the consultation payload as appointment_status. This tracks the underlying booking/slot, which is a separate concept from the session status above.

Value	Meaning
pending	Reserved value; the booking flow below creates appointments as confirmed directly
confirmed	Slot is held; this is the state a freshly booked consultation's appointment will be in
completed	Set automatically when the consultation is completed

Value	Meaning
cancelled	Set automatically when the consultation is cancelled
no_show	Reserved value — not yet set by any endpoint below

4.4 Lifecycle

Valid consultation.status transitions enforced server-side:



Only scheduled or waiting consultations can be started; only in_progress consultations can be completed or prescribed against; cancellation is only allowed from scheduled or waiting.

5. Related endpoints (Doctors module)

These three endpoints live outside this module, under /api/ (not /api/consultations/), but the booking flow in Section 7.1 depends on them. Summarized briefly here for convenience — for full field-by-field detail, error shapes, and any endpoints beyond these three, see the Doctors module's own integration guide.

5.1 List specialties

GET	/api/specialties/	Any authenticated user
------------	-------------------	------------------------

Returns active specialties for populating a category filter/search step before choosing a doctor. Response: array of { id, name, description }.

5.2 List doctors

GET	/api/doctors/? specialty={id}	Any authenticated user
------------	----------------------------------	------------------------

Returns doctors, optionally filtered by specialty id, for a “choose a doctor” screen. Response includes each doctor's id, name, specialty, years of experience, consultation_fee, and consultation_duration — the latter two drive the price shown at booking and the slot length used by the availability endpoint below.

5.3 Get doctor availability

GET	/api/doctors/{id}/ availability/	Any authenticated user
------------	-------------------------------------	------------------------

Returns the selected doctor's availability windows/slots for use when picking an appointment_date and appointment_time in Section 6.1. Confirm the exact response shape (windows vs. pre-expanded slots) and any date query parameters against the Doctors module's own docs before building the date/time picker.

6. Consultation endpoints

All paths below are relative to `/api/consultations/`.

6.1 Book a consultation

POST	<code>/api/consultations/</code>	<i>Patient</i>
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Creates the appointment and its consultation record in one call. On success, the appointment is created directly as confirmed and the consultation's price is snapshotted from the doctor's current consultation_fee.

Request body

Field	Type	Description
<code>doctor_id</code>	int	Required. Must be an approved doctor.
<code>appointment_date</code>	date	Required. Today or later.
<code>appointment_time</code>	time	Required. Must be later than now if the date is today.
<code>consultation_type</code>	string	Optional, default "video". "video" or "audio".
<code>language</code>	string	Optional, default "en". "en" or "am".
<code>reason_for_visit</code>	string	Optional, default "Digital consultation".

```
{
  "doctor_id": 12,
  "appointment_date": "2026-09-02",
  "appointment_time": "10:00:00",
  "consultation_type": "video",
  "language": "en",
  "reason_for_visit": "Skin rash follow-up"
}
```

Success response (201)

```
{
  "id": 42,
  "appointment": 101,
  "patient_name": "Selam Tesfaye",
  "doctor_name": "Dr. Abel Getachew",
  "specialty_name": "Dermatology",
  "appointment_date": "2026-09-02",
  "appointment_time": "10:00:00",
  "duration_minutes": 30,
  "appointment_status": "confirmed",
  "consultation_type": "video",
  "language": "en",
  "status": "scheduled",
  "price": "500.00",
}
```

```

"currency": "ETB",
"meeting_url": "",
"started_at": null,
"ended_at": null,
"created_at": "2026-08-30T09:12:00Z",
"updated_at": "2026-08-30T09:12:00Z"
}

```

Error responses

Status	Body / condition
400 (field)	Missing/invalid field, or doctor_id references a doctor that isn't approved
400 (detail)	"This slot is no longer available. Please choose another time." (also covers the exact-slot race and any Appointment.clean() failure, e.g. outside the doctor's working hours)
403	Authenticated user has no linked patient profile

Note

meeting_url is empty at booking time; it is populated when the doctor starts the session (6.5). Don't show a "join" control until status is in_progress and meeting_url is non-empty.

6.2 List my consultations

GET	/api/consultations/mine/	Patient
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Returns every consultation for the authenticated patient, most recent appointment first. There is currently no equivalent list endpoint for a doctor's own consultations.

Success response (200)

```
[ { /* same shape as the booking response, Section 6.1 */ } ]
```

Error responses

Status	Body / condition
403	Authenticated user has no linked patient profile

Note

This endpoint is unpaginated. If a patient's history grows large, expect a slow response until server-side pagination is added — don't build the list screen assuming a bounded page size yet.

6.3 Get consultation detail

GET	<code>/api/consultations/{id}/</code>	<i>Patient (own consultation only)</i>
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Fetches a single consultation. Use this to poll for status/meeting_url changes on a “waiting room” screen, since there is no push/websocket channel yet.

Success response (200)

```
{ /* same shape as the booking response, Section 6.1 */ }
```

Error responses

Status	Body / condition
404	Consultation doesn't exist, or belongs to a different patient

6.4 Cancel a consultation

POST	<code>/api/consultations/{id}/cancel/</code>	<i>Patient (own consultation only)</i>
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Cancels the consultation and its underlying appointment together. Only allowed while status is scheduled or waiting.

Request body

Field	Type	Description
reason	string	Optional, defaults to an empty string

```
{
  "reason": "Patient requested reschedule"
}
```

Success response (200)

```
{ /* updated consultation, status: "cancelled" */ }
```

Error responses

Status	Body / condition
400	"Cannot cancel a consultation with status 'in_progress'." (or completed / cancelled / no_show)
404	Consultation doesn't exist, or belongs to a different patient

Note

Once a session is `in_progress`, cancellation is no longer offered by the API — remove/disable the cancel action in the UI at that point rather than relying on the error alone.

6.5 Start a consultation

POST	<code>/api/consultations/{id}/start/</code>	<i>Doctor (assigned doctor only)</i>
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Marks the session `in_progress`, timestamps `started_at`, and assigns `meeting_url` if one hasn't been set yet. Only allowed from `scheduled` or `waiting`, and only if the underlying appointment is confirmed.

Success response (200)

```
{
  "id": 42,
  "...": "...",
  "status": "in_progress",
  "meeting_url": "https://meet.example.com/6f2c...",
  "started_at": "2026-09-02T10:01:04Z"
}
```

Error responses

Status	Body / condition
400	"Cannot start a consultation with status '...' or "The underlying appointment is not confirmed."
403	Authenticated user has no linked doctor profile
404	Consultation doesn't exist, or isn't assigned to this doctor

Note

Poll or re-fetch the consultation (6.3) from the patient's client after this call to reveal the join link — the patient side has no notification when the doctor starts.

6.6 Complete a consultation

POST	<code>/api/consultations/{id}/complete/</code>	<i>Doctor (assigned doctor only)</i>
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Marks the session completed and timestamps `ended_at`. Only allowed from `in_progress`.

Success response (200)

```
{ /* updated consultation, status: "completed", ended_at set */ }
```

Error responses

Status	Body / condition
400	"Cannot complete a consultation with status '...'"
403	Authenticated user has no linked doctor profile
404	Consultation doesn't exist, or isn't assigned to this doctor

6.7 Create a prescription

POST	/api/consultations/{id}/prescriptions/	<i>Doctor (assigned doctor only)</i>
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Adds one prescription line to a consultation. Only allowed while the consultation is in_progress or completed. Call it once per medication — there is no bulk/multi-item variant.

Request body

Field	Type	Description
medication	string	Required
dosage	string	Required
frequency	string	Required
duration	string	Required
instructions	string	Required

```
{
  "medication": "Amoxicillin",
  "dosage": "500mg",
  "frequency": "3 times daily",
  "duration": "7 days",
  "instructions": "Take after meals. Complete the full course."
}
```

Success response (201)

```
{
  "id": 5,
  "consultation": 42,
  "patient_name": "Selam Tesfaye",
  "doctor_name": "Dr. Abel Getachew",
  "medication": "Amoxicillin",
  "dosage": "500mg",
  "frequency": "3 times daily",
  "duration": "7 days",
  "instructions": "Take after meals. Complete the full course.",
  "created_at": "2026-09-02T10:22:00Z",
  "updated_at": "2026-09-02T10:22:00Z"
}
```

Error responses

Status	Body / condition
400 (field)	Any of the five fields missing or blank
400 (detail)	"Prescriptions can only be created during or after the consultation."
403	Authenticated user has no linked doctor profile
404	Consultation doesn't exist, or isn't assigned to this doctor

Note

There is no GET list endpoint for prescriptions in this module yet — if the patient needs to view them, request that endpoint before building the prescriptions tab, or read them off the consultation via a future nested field.

7. Suggested frontend flows

7.1 Patient: book a consultation

- 1. GET /api/specialties/ — render a category picker.
- 2. GET /api/doctors/?specialty={id} — render doctor cards (fee, experience, bio).
- 3. Patient picks a date → GET /api/doctors/{id}/availability/ → render slots, disabling unavailable ones.
- 4. Patient picks a slot and confirms → POST /api/consultations/ with the selected doctor/date/time.
- 5. On 201, navigate to the consultation detail screen using the returned id.
- 6. On 400 with a “slot no longer available” detail, re-fetch availability (step 3) and ask the patient to reselect — don't just retry the same payload.

7.2 Patient: join and manage a booked consultation

- 1. GET /api/consultations/mine/ for the list; GET /api/consultations/{id}/ for a single one.
- 2. While status is scheduled or waiting, show a Cancel action → POST /api/consultations/{id}/cancel/.
- 3. Poll GET /api/consultations/{id}/ (e.g. every 10–15s) as the appointment time approaches — once status flips to in_progress and meeting_url is non-empty, show the Join action.
- 4. Once status is completed, stop polling and surface any prescriptions once that read endpoint exists (see 6.7 note).

7.3 Doctor: run a consultation

- 1. Until a doctor-scoped list endpoint exists, the doctor client needs the consultation id from elsewhere (e.g. an appointments/schedule module) to call the endpoints below.
- 2. POST /api/consultations/{id}/start/ when the doctor begins the session — use the returned meeting_url to launch the call UI.

- 3. POST /api/consultations/{id}/prescriptions/ any number of times during or after the session to record medications.
- 4. POST /api/consultations/{id}/complete/ to close out the session.

8. Open items for the backend team

Flagging these now so frontend work isn't blocked later by assumptions that don't hold:

- No endpoint currently lists a doctor's own consultations (needed for a doctor dashboard/schedule view).
- No endpoint lists prescriptions for a consultation (needed for a patient-facing prescription history/e-prescription view).
- No push/websocket channel for status changes — join-call and waiting-room UX must rely on polling GET /{id}/ for now.
- meeting_url is a placeholder value in the current backend implementation; confirm the real video-provider integration before building the in-call UI against its URL shape.
- The waiting and no_show statuses are defined but nothing currently sets them — don't build UI branches for them until a corresponding endpoint exists.